



Peräjärvi '95

My Summer Car 1.0 + MSCLoader

Modlist · Installation · Field Manual · Personae

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1 Installation

From a vanilla My Summer Car 1.0 to a modded garage in four steps: game, loader, mods, verify.

1.1 What you need

Item	Value
Base game	My Summer Car 1.0 — Steam (final build; out of Early Access 2025-01-08)
Mod manager	MSCLoader — the community-standard loader (v1.4.2 at the time of writing)
Mods	The 6 curated mods from chapter 2
Sources	Steam · Nexus Mods (mysummercar) · GitHub (piotruslos/MSCMod-Loader) · OverTake.gg

My Summer Car is a finished product: 1.0 shipped in January 2025 and Steam keeps the game on the final stable build automatically. There is no “beta branch” you need — install the current build and leave it on default settings.

Good to know

Everything in this guide is downloaded from exactly four trusted hubs: Steam, Nexus Mods, the official MSCLoader GitHub, and OverTake.gg. Never grab MSC mods from random repack or aggregator sites.

1.2 Step 1 — Install and launch the game

1. Install **My Summer Car** from Steam. The game folder is typically `Steam\steamapps\common\My Summer Car`.
2. Launch the game once and start a new save so the game generates its files and folder structure.
3. Quit and verify the game runs unmodded first. If anything is wrong, fix it before touching mods.

1.3 Step 2 — Install MSCLoader (the mod manager)

MSCLoader is the mod manager for the avid modder: it loads C# plugins, shows every installed mod with its version in an in-game mod menu, exposes per-mod settings, and is the ecosystem nearly every current My Summer Car mod is built for. It is open source (GPL-3.0) and maintained by the same author as several popular mods.

The official install flow (from the loader’s README — follow it exactly):

1. Download the latest release from [the MSCLoader GitHub releases](#) (or the [Nexus page](#)).
2. Unpack the archive **anywhere you want — never inside any game folder**.
3. Run `MSCLInstaller.exe`.
4. If your game path was not found automatically, select the My Summer Car folder manually.
5. Select **“Install MSCLoader”** and click the **“Select option”** button.
6. Choose the folder that will hold your mods — the game folder is the recommended, simplest choice.
7. Wait for the install to finish. The loader is now part of the game.

Tip

The same installer can also **uninstall** the loader cleanly. If you ever want to go back to a completely vanilla game, re-run `MSCLInstaller.exe` and use its uninstall option.

1.4 Step 3 — Install the mods

Every mod in chapter 2 has its own **Install** line, but they all follow the same pattern:

1. Download the mod from its page (Nexus Mods or OverTake.gg).
2. Unpack the archive — do not place `.zip` files into the mods folder.
3. Copy the mod's contents (a folder containing the `.dll` and any assets) into the **Mods** folder you chose in step 2.
4. Some mods need extra setup — e.g. *Cassette Tapes* wants a *Radio* folder for your music. Those notes are on the mod cards.

Watch out

Before your first modded launch, back up your save — the file is `defaultES2File.txt` in the game's saves folder. Mods are generally safe, but saves are cheap to copy and expensive to lose.

1.5 Step 4 — Verify and first launch

1. Launch the game through Steam. The loader boots with the game.
2. Open the loader's mod menu (the exact key/menu entry is shown in the loader's own documentation; the game's settings screen also lists loader options).
3. All installed mods should show as **loaded/active**. A mod shown in red means it failed to load — usually an outdated mod or a missing dependency. Check the mod's Nexus posts/bugs tab for the fix.
4. If a mod misbehaves, the game writes `output_log.txt` in the game folder — this file is what mod authors and the community will ask for when you report an issue.

Good to know

Mods can be enabled and disabled individually from the loader's menu — that is the first troubleshooting move for any problem, and it makes testing new additions safe.

1.6 Updating and removing mods

- **Update a mod:** replace its folder in the Mods folder with the new version from its page.
- **Remove a mod:** delete its folder from the Mods folder.
- **Update the loader:** download the new release and re-run `MSCLInstaller.exe` — your mods folder and saves are untouched.
- After any change, launch and check the loader's mod list once before playing on.

1.7 Safety rules

- Only Nexus Mods, the official MSCLoader GitHub, and OverTake.gg in this guide.
- Read the **Requirements** section of every mod page — most mods need the latest MSCLoader.
- Check the **Last updated** date: for a finished game, old mods are the main compatibility risk, not new ones.
- Keep one save backup from before modding, and one from before each big mod change.

2 The Modlist

What “Peräjärvi ‘95” actually consists of: the final *My Summer Car 1.0* plus nine curated mods on MSCLoader — and, just as importantly, what it deliberately leaves out.

2.1 The list at a glance

Property	Value
Base game	My Summer Car 1.0 (final build, out of Early Access 2025-01-08)
Mod manager	MSCLoader v1.4.2 (2026-06-21) — Nexus mods/147 · GitHub piotrulos/MSCModLoader
Curated mods	9 — one visual overhaul, one performance/stability pass, seven detail, immersion & navigation mods
Distribution	Nexus Mods (mysummercar) + OverTake.gg — direct pages only
Playstyle	The vanilla sim, deepened and modernized — nothing that makes it easier

2.2 Design pillars

- **Deepen & modernize.** The game is a finished 2016-era sim; these mods stabilize its performance and make its world feel alive and current — without moving the goalposts.
- **Graphics, honestly.** One serious visual overhaul (post-processing, sky, weather, reflections) plus the performance pass that pays for it. No fake “ultra” filters that only smear the image.
- **Details.** Small, physical touches that a mechanic would notice: wear you can see, light switches you can find, tapes you can actually buy and play.
- **No overpowered, no easier.** Nothing that raises money, capacity, or success rates; nothing that erases a mechanic the game teaches you by doing. Mods that do exactly that are listed at the end of this chapter with reasons — they are the ones we said no to.

2.3 The core: MSCLoader

MSCLoader is the **best mod manager for an avid modder** in this community, and it is the only one this guide uses:

- It is the de-facto standard — nearly every current mod is a loader plugin, so one manager covers the whole ecosystem.
- It gives you a real **mod menu in-game**: list every mod, see versions, enable/disable individually, and reach each mod’s settings from one place.
- It is actively maintained (v1.4.2, June 2026) and open source, with a public wiki for modders and users.
- It does **not** need external launchers or profile juggling — the installer wires it into the game and your Mods folder is the whole management surface.

Good to know

One warning that comes from the mods themselves: **Mod Loader Pro** is a different, older loader from a different author. Modern mods — including Better Graphics — do not support it. If a mod page asks for “Mod Loader Pro”, treat it as a legacy-mod red flag.

2.4 The mods

2.4.1 Foundation

MSCLoader

Required — the mod manager

The community-standard mod loader for My Summer Car: a C# plugin loader with an in-game mod menu, per-mod settings, version listing, and enable/disable per mod. Everything else in this list runs on top of it. Open source (GPL-3.0), same author as Cassette Tapes.

Where: Nexus — [mysummercar/mods/147](#) · [github.com/piotrulos/MSCModLoader](#)

Install: Unpack anywhere except the game folder, run MSCInstaller.exe, point it at the game, install, then drop mods into the Mods folder you chose.

Risk: None — it is the ecosystem itself. Keep it updated; old loader versions break with new mods.

2.4.2 Performance & stability

Reharmonization

Performance · by Horsey4

Rewrites some of the game's poorly written code paths for stable frame rates and smoother simulation. The successor to FSMO and the safe, actively recommended replacement for the abandoned MOP. Everything can be toggled in-game, per optimization, with a time-slicing slider for the aggressive fixes.

Where: Nexus — [mysummercar/mods/3152](#)

Install: Extract the .dll into your Mods folder. Open its settings in the loader's mod menu.

Risk: Low. If you ever see odd behavior (e.g. loading issues), disable the 'FSM Loop Limit' optimization or lower the time-slicing — the community-documented first fix.

2.4.3 Graphics

Better Graphics

Visual overhaul · by Bosorkanamettle · v2.0

The modernizer: depth of field / tilt-shift, day & night bloom, ambient obscurance (SSAO), tonemapping, anti-aliasing, screen-space reflections with quality slider, sunshafts anchored to the sun, adjustable sun cascades and shadow distance, the old-build skybox plus a night sky with a moonlight system, random foggy weather, a rebuilt lake, car mirror overhaul, remade headlight glass and emission, wet roads after rain, remade thunder, glowing garage lights, and a few extras from the cancelled map expansion (the abandoned mansion with its Halloween event, the park, air balloons — plus re-added roaming NPCs).

Where: Nexus — [mysummercar/mods/4103](#)

Install: Extract into your Mods folder. Most effects are blended into the in-game Graphics tab; the rest live in the loader's 'Mod Settings'.

Risk: GPU-heavy — the author is explicit that weak PCs will drop frames. Mod Loader Pro is NOT supported. A few extras (mouse controls, hand shadows) are experimental and unreliable; leave them off.

Satsuma Gauges Revamp

Graphics detail

High-resolution retexture of the Satsuma's instrument cluster — sharper dials and markings instead of the stock low-res gauge textures, with style options (the default look or the '1XR' variant) to suit the interior. Purely cosmetic: the instruments behave exactly as in the vanilla game.

Where: Nexus — [mysummercar/mods/8320](#)

Install: Extract into your Mods folder. Pick your preferred gauge style from the mod's options.

Risk: Low — textures only. Check the page for notes on combining it with other interior mods.

2.4.4 Detail & immersion

Traffic Car Expansion

Living world

Overhauls the road traffic: 30+ unique vehicle models with randomized colors, wheels, license plates and trim levels, plus smarter AI — turn signals, emergency lights, reversing lights, obstacle awareness, dynamic traffic density, and drivers flashing their headlights to warn you of police posts. Rare NPC encounters included.

Where: Nexus — [mysummercar/mods/4299](#)

Install: Extract into your Mods folder.

Risk: CPU-heavy — expect a hit on weaker machines. Do not combine with MOP-era mods; it targets the modern loader stack.

Visual Wear

Detail

Lets you see the condition of your parts: transmission, head gasket, oil filter, tires and more visibly age as they wear, so you can judge maintenance at a glance instead of guessing. Also pops the caps off bottles (coolant, brake fluid...) when they run empty — a small, physical touch.

Where: Nexus — [mysummercar/mods/5544](#)

Install: Extract into your Mods folder.

Risk: Low. Textures only — no balance changes.

Openable Cabinets

Detail

Makes the house and the cabin's storage real: an openable living-room shelf, the player wardrobe, kitchen cabinets and Ventti cabinets, each with working doors, sounds and space for your stuff. Organized clutter instead of piles on the floor — and the author explicitly does not support the outdated MOP/Pro Loader stack, which matches this guide.

Where: Nexus — [mysummercar/mods/4037](#)

Install: Extract into your Mods folder. The new cabinets appear around the house and cabin.

Risk: Low. v1.1 fixed item-grab-through and collider issues; report oddities with output_log.txt.

Lights on Switches

Detail

Adds a subtle, lore-friendly glow to the light switches in your home, so you can find them in the dark without fumbling along the wall. Small, but it removes real friction from the night hours.

Where: Nexus — [mysummercar/mods/868](#)

Install: Extract into your Mods folder.

Risk: None.

Cassette Tapes

Immersion · by piotrułos

Custom music on real cassettes: each subfolder in the Radio folder is one tape you buy at Teimo's shop and play in the boombox or any car radio — with rewind, eject, and the playback position remembered. Supports mp3, flac, ogg, wav and aiff, with custom labels and cover art.

Where: OverTake.gg — search “Cassette Tapes” (My Summer Car)

Install: Extract into your Mods folder, then set up the Radio folder: one subfolder per tape, your music inside. Buy the tapes at Teimo's.

Risk: Low. Needs an OverTake account to download. Tapes do not work in the CD player — by design.

2.4.5 Modernization & navigation

Minimap

Navigation · by RedJohn260

A HUD minimap with a toggleable big map: day/night modes, automatic zoom by vehicle speed, a compass, a map legend, and icons for major locations, NPC vehicles and discovered car wrecks. It also flashes job icons when jobs (sewage, wood, booze) are available — a genuine aid for the working summer. Toggle with the rebindable default keys (Ctrl+Numpad9 for the minimap, Ctrl+Numpad5 for the big map). Explicitly compatible with Better Graphics.

Where: Nexus — [mysummercar/mods/326](#)

Install: Extract into your Mods folder. Toggle keys and visible icons are configurable in the loader's mod settings.

Risk: Low. Actively maintained; the map is based on the in-game one, so a few minor landmarks may be slightly off.

Good to know

The minimap is the one ‘modern comfort’ in the list — toggle it off whenever you want the pure 1995 navigation experience.

2.5 What we deliberately left out

Every mod below is real and some are popular — and each one fails a pillar. The reasons are recorded in STATUS.md as well.

- **MOP (Modern Optimization Plugin)** — abandoned; community-documented save corruption and physics bugs. Reharmonization does the job safely.
- **Fuel Tank Door and other Mod Loader Pro-era mods** — require the legacy Mod Loader Pro, which the modern ecosystem (and Better Graphics explicitly) does not support.
- **Delivery Jobs** — a great concept (package deliveries with a damage system), but it has been removed from Nexus and survives only on unofficial rehosts: no verifiable source.
- **Show Bolt Sizes** — removes the wrench-size trial-and-error. Finding the right wrench is a core hands-on mechanic of the build; erasing it makes the game easier.
- **Carry More / backpack mods** — raise your carry capacity, which softens inventory management. Same pillar violation.
- **Expanded Winter Features** — a full season overhaul that fights the summer setting and the weather systems Better Graphics is tuned for.
- **Engine Info** — tagged “Cheating” by the community: it reveals exact internal values (wear percentages, fluid levels, tuning parameters) at a keypress. Diagnosis is part of the game’s difficulty; Visual Wear shows wear honestly, without the readout. It is also unmaintained since 2020, predating the 1.0 build.
- **SatsumaFPSOptimization** — buys frames by hiding the Satsuma’s engine model in drive mode. A visible part of the car disappears; Reharmonization covers the performance base without hiding anything.
- **Standalone “4K/HD” texture packs and engine-sound overhauls** — there is no community-standard, maintained option: they are fragmented, often legacy-loader or manual asset-replacement mods that break on game updates. Better Graphics, Satsuma Gauges Revamp and the rest of this list cover those pillars with far less risk.
- **Deeper crash/deformation physics** — not feasible on this engine: damage states are pre-scripted. Treat any “realistic crumple” promise with suspicion.

Good to know

The line we draw: **friction you can feel is the game**. Detail mods and honest performance work deepen it; anything that quietly removes a mechanic, a limit, or a source of tension is out — even when it is popular.

2.6 Download sources

- Nexus Mods — My Summer Car hub: nexusmods.com/mysummericar (loader + five of the six mods)
- MSCLoader releases: github.com/piotrulos/MSCModLoader/releases
- OverTake.gg: overtake.gg (Cassette Tapes)

Every mod card above links its own page — check the **Requirements** and **Last updated** fields there before installing; versions move faster than any printed guide.

3 How to Play

A field manual for the modded summer: the daily loop, making money, building the Satsuma, passing the inspection, and what the mods change once you are in.

3.1 What the game actually is

It is the summer of 1995 in rural Finland, and you are a young man with a wreck of a car in the garage — a **Satsuma** (a 1.0-litre, four-cylinder, rear-wheel-drive box that was your father's). Your job is to rebuild it from parts, make it road-legal, and pass the inspection. Around that task grows a small open-world simulator: you must eat, drink, sleep, earn money, and deal with a village full of characters.

There is no quest marker that hands you a car. The game's difficulty **is** the process: parts must be ordered, bolted, wired, filled with fluids and tuned — and the money to buy them has to be earned. This guide's mods deepen that process; they do not shorten it.

3.2 The daily loop

Your character has needs: **hunger, thirst, bladder and sleep**. Ignore them and you move slower, then pass out — or worse. The loop of every day is:

1. Wake up (sleeping in your bed is also the save game).
2. Eat and drink — food in the fridge and at Teimo's shop; coffee, milk, beer and soda as needed.
3. Check the phone for messages and errands.
4. Do a job or work on the car.
5. Sleep to save and reset the day.

Tip

Sleep is the only save. If you die — an engine explosion, a crash, thirst in the middle of nowhere — everything since your last sleep is gone. Treat “sleep before risky work” as a habit, not an option.

3.3 Money and jobs

You start with a small sum, and parts are not cheap. The reliable ways to earn:

- **Firewood** — at grandma's house: split logs into firewood for a few marks a stack. Slow but safe and always available.
- **Friday advert delivery** — at Teimo's shop: deliver advertising sheets to mailboxes around the village for a payout. A classic early job.
- **The night shuttle** — at the pub: drive patrons home after closing. Decent money, but you are driving tired people around in the dark.

- **Hauling** — with the tractor and trailer (and later the van): moving stuff around the village for people who ask.
- **The phone** — mom, grandma, Jokke and Fleetari call with errands and opportunities. Answer it.

Good to know

Until the Satsuma is built and inspected, you get around on foot, by bike, with the van and the tractor — which are exactly as useful (and as awkward) as they sound. That is the intended friction, not a bug.

3.4 Building the Satsuma

3.4.1 Ordering parts

Car parts come from **Fleetari's repair shop**; groceries, fluids and sundries from **Teimo's shop**. Use the phone at home to place orders, then pick them up at the shop. If a part is missing, it is probably still on order — or you forgot to bolt something on.

3.4.2 Assembly order

The car assembles in layers; a sensible order:

1. **Chassis & suspension** — rear axle, leaf springs, dampers, brake components; front suspension with its springs, dampers and steering rack; then the wheels.
2. **Engine bottom end** — engine block, crankshaft, connecting rods, pistons and rings.
3. **Engine top end** — cylinder head, valves, camshaft, rocker arms, timing belt.
4. **Ancillaries** — oil pan, oil filter, alternator, starter, distributor, spark plugs, belts.
5. **Intake & exhaust** — manifolds, carburetor, exhaust headers, pipe, muffler.
6. **Drivetrain** — clutch, gearbox, driveshaft, and the axles it all connects to.
7. **Cooling & fuel** — radiator, fan, hoses; fuel tank, fuel lines, fuel filter.
8. **Electrical** — battery, battery cables, the wiring harness, dashboard and gauges, lights, horn, wipers.
9. **Interior & body** — seats, steering wheel, doors, hood, bumpers, mirrors, glass.
10. **Fluids & lube** — engine oil, coolant, brake fluid, clutch fluid, gear oil — then fuel at the pump.

Watch out

The most common “why won't it start” causes, in order: no fuel, dead battery, no spark (wiring or distributor), no compression (valves or timing belt), or a part you were sure you bolted on. Work through them in that order and it will start.

3.5 Tuning and starting

A built engine is not a running engine. Before the first start: correct valve clearances, camshaft and timing belt tension, spark plug gaps, and the distributor's ignition timing. Then the carburetor's mixture and idle screws.

The first start: ignition key, choke for a cold engine, and patience — a fresh build often needs a few tries. After it fires, let it idle and warm up before touching the throttle. A brand-new engine should be **run in** gently: short trips, no redline for a while. It is a 1.0-litre — treat it like a small, fragile heart, because it is.

3.6 Roadworthiness — the inspection

A few days in, the **inspector, Korhonen**, arrives at your home to check the car. The Satsuma must be road-legal: working lights (headlights, tail lights, indicators), horn, mirrors, seatbelts, wipers, proper tires, a quiet muffler, and everything bolted on properly. He tells you what is wrong and gives you a deadline — fix what he flagged and he will come back.

Passing the inspection is the game's first real milestone: the Satsuma is now a legal car, and the summer opens up.

Tip

Before he comes, walk around the car at dusk with the lights on and check every corner. A missing bolt is cheaper than a failed inspection — and cheaper still than finding out on the road.

3.7 Driving in 1995

The Satsuma is a manual-gearbox rear-driver with no assists. Practical notes:

- **Clutch and gears** are physical: revs, shift, engage. Stall it and you restart — that is the game.
- **Fuel** comes from the pumps at Teimo's shop. Watch the gauge; running dry on a dirt road is a walk home.
- **Don't over-rev or overheat.** The engine is the most expensive part you own. Oil it, cool it, respect it.
- **The police exist.** Speeding and reckless driving earn fines; drunk driving has real consequences. The modded traffic (chapter 2) makes the roads livelier — drive accordingly.
- **Handbrake turns** work exactly as well as they do in real life: great on gravel, expensive in a ditch.

3.8 Racing and events

Once the Satsuma is legal, it has a second life: **racing events** — drag racing and gravel rallies around the map. Entry is cheap, tuning matters, and the prize money is real. This is where the build pays off: a well-assembled, well-tuned car genuinely outperforms a slapped-together one.

3.9 The modded experience

What the six mods change once you are playing:

- **MSCLoader** — open the mod menu to see every mod, check versions, and reach per-mod settings. This is your dashboard.
- **Better Graphics** — tune it in the Graphics tab and the loader's Mod Settings: tonemapping type, anti-aliasing, reflection quality, sun cascades, shadow distance, bloom thresholds (day and night), sunshafts. The old-build skybox, night sky and moonlight change the mood completely; the foggy weather and rebuilt lake make the map feel new. If frames drop, lower reflections and shadows first.
- **Reharmonization** — everything is toggleable in its settings; if something odd happens, disable "FSM Loop Limit" or reduce time-slicing.
- **Traffic Car Expansion** — more and smarter traffic. Note the headlight flashes from oncoming drivers: that is a **warning** — a police post is ahead. The rare encounters are worth slowing down for.
- **Visual Wear** — use it: when a part looks tired, it is. Check the oil filter, head gasket area and tires before long drives; the empty bottle caps tell you when fluids ran out.
- **Satsuma Gauges Revamp** — purely cosmetic: the new dials read exactly like the stock ones, just sharper.
- **Lights on Switches** — find the glow, flip the light, carry on.
- **Cassette Tapes** — make your tapes (Radio folder → one subfolder per tape → music inside), buy them at Teimo's, and play them in the boombox or the car radio. Rewind works. The CD player will not take them.
- **Openable Cabinets** — the wardrobe, kitchen cabinets, shelf and Ventti cabinets at home hold your parts and groceries like any container. No more floor piles.
- **Minimap** — the HUD map shows where you are, which jobs are open (flashing icons) and which wrecks you have found; toggle it with its key whenever you want the unassisted 1995 experience.

3.10 Saves, backups & troubleshooting

- **Saving:** sleep in bed.

- **Backups:** copy `defaultES2File.txt` from the saves folder before big mod changes and before ambitious builds.
- **Mod problems:** a mod listed in red in the loader menu is outdated or incompatible — check its Nexus page, or disable it and test.
- **Crashes:** `output_log.txt` in the game folder is the report the community will ask for. Include it when you ask for help.
- **Isolation:** when something breaks, disable mods one at a time — the loader makes this a two-minute job.

3.11 How to die less (a checklist)

- Eat, drink and sleep before long jobs — never drive half-starved.
- Sleep before risky work: the save point is the point.
- Bolt everything, twice. A wheel that comes off at speed ends the run.
- Watch the gauges: fuel, temperature, oil.
- Run in a new engine before you race it.
- Do not drive drunk — in-game or otherwise.
- When in doubt, walk around the car and look at it. The game rewards the careful mechanic.

4 Personas

Who are you this summer? Five ways to play the same 1995 — each with a background and the game creation choices that make it yours.

4.1 Before you start: how “creation” works here

My Summer Car has no character creator — no name entry, no appearance sliders. Your identity is what you **decide**:

- **The name.** Edit the save with MSC Editor: open `defaultES2File.txt`, find the player section, and set `playerfirstname` / `playerlastname` to whatever you like. The community tradition is a Finnish name — and if you want to feel like part of the village, the surname **Kesseli** matches the in-game Kesseli family.
- **The rules.** Every persona below sets its own house rules: what you may buy, what you must do, what counts as winning. This is the real “game creation” — the difficulty comes from the rules you keep, not from a menu.
- **The mods.** Chapter 2’s list is one installation; each persona simply leans on the mods that matter to its playstyle.

Good to know

All five personas are playable on the same modlist — the personas differ in goals and self-imposed rules, not in mods. Switch between them on different saves; keep one backup per persona.

4.2 1. The Restorer

The Restorer

Difficulty: medium · Focus: the car

Background. Your father's Satsuma sat in the garage for a decade, and you mean to bring it back exactly as it left the factory — every bolt, every adjustment, the right paint. You are not in a hurry; you are doing it properly. The village will see a showroom car by the end of summer, and Korhonen's inspection will be a formality.

Game creation choices

- **Name:** something steady — “Juha Kesseli” works, or any Finnish name you like. Edit it in MSC Editor.

- **House rules:** buy only correct, proper parts — no salvaged shortcuts, no tuning for power. Original everything; keep the engine stock.
- **Priorities:** finish each assembly step completely before starting the next; fluids and torque before anything else; drive gently once it is road-legal.
- **Goal:** a spotless, fully legal, fully original Satsuma — the inspection passed first time with nothing flagged.
- **Mods that shine:** Visual Wear (spot worn parts before they embarrass you), Better Graphics (enjoy the showroom look), Satsuma Gauges Revamp (a dash as sharp as the paint), Lights on Switches.

4.3 2. The Rally Driver

The Rally Driver

Difficulty: medium · Focus: speed

Background. You grew up on gravel roads and you know exactly what a 1.0-litre with the right setup can do. The Satsuma is not a project — it is a chassis waiting for a build sheet. Money goes into racing parts, tuning, and seat time; the inspection is just a checkpoint on the way to the grid.

Game creation choices

- **Name:** a driver's name — “Timo Virtanen” and the like.
- **House rules:** every markka earned goes toward performance parts; the build prioritizes the engine, suspension and weight; you may tune aggressively — and accept the consequences.
- **Priorities:** earn via the night shuttle and racing payouts; run the engine in quickly but thoroughly; practice launches and gravel technique.
- **Goal:** win — drag and rally events both, with a reputation on the dirt.
- **Mods that shine:** Traffic Car Expansion (a living road scene), Better Graphics (motion blur and tilt-shift sell the speed), Satsuma Gauges Revamp (clear dials at speed), Visual Wear (a race engine eats parts — watch them).

4.4 3. The Workhorse

The Workhorse

Difficulty: medium · Focus: the economy

Background. Nobody is handing you this car. You take every job the village offers — firewood at grandma's, Friday flyers, the night shuttle, hauling — and the Satsuma is built mark by mark. You know the price of every part because you earned it, and by August the garage holds the proof.

Game creation choices

- **Name:** a working man's name — “Esa Miettinen”.
- **House rules:** the car is bought with earned money only — no shortcuts, no freebies; the daily loop is job-first, build-second.
- **Priorities:** learn the job routes and payouts; bank money for the big parts; use the van and tractor well before the Satsuma exists.
- **Goal:** a fully built, inspected Satsuma funded entirely by honest work — and a comfortable bank balance to show for the summer.
- **Mods that shine:** Cassette Tapes (the radio makes long hauling tolerable), Minimap (see which jobs are open before you drive out), Openable Cabinets (organize the haul at home), Traffic Car Expansion (roads worth sharing), Visual Wear (keep the work vehicle alive).

4.5 4. The Stoic

The Stoic

Difficulty: hard · Focus: no shortcuts

Background. You play the game the way it is written: no help, no comfort, no beer. Everything the Satsuma needs is earned the hard way, salvaged where possible, and fitted by hand. The summer will test your patience — that is the point. This is the persona for the player who has done it once the easy way.

Game creation choices

- **Name:** something plain — “Pekka Ahonen”.
- **House rules: no beer** (it is a cheap food-and-drink staple — refusing it makes hunger management real); salvage and reuse what you can find before buying new; never take the easy transport; sleep only at home.
- **Priorities:** firewood and the slow jobs; hunt for usable parts; build methodically and maintain everything.
- **Goal:** the Satsuma, assembled from the hardest possible summer — every markka honestly earned, every part honestly fitted.
- **Mods that shine:** Visual Wear (essential — you cannot afford surprises), Reharmonization (stable frames while you grind), Better Graphics (the fog and storms make the struggle atmospheric).

Watch out

The Stoic is a self-imposed hard mode. If the first week stops being fun, relax one rule — the persona is a lens, not a vow.

4.6 5. The Cruiser

The Cruiser

Difficulty: easy-going · Focus: the summer

Background. You came to the village for the season: a borrowed garage, a wreck with potential, and no particular hurry. The Satsuma gets built between long drives, cassette tapes, and evenings at the pub. The inspection will happen eventually — the summer is what you are actually here for.

Game creation choices

- **Name:** an easygoing name — “Antti Koskinen”.
- **House rules:** no grinding — do the jobs that appeal; spend on comfort (food, tapes, paint) as well as parts; enjoy the world.
- **Priorities:** build at your own pace; take the Satsuma out for pleasure drives once it is legal; spectate the racing scene.
- **Goal:** a road-legal Satsuma by summer’s end, a stack of cassette tapes, and no regrets.
- **Mods that shine:** Cassette Tapes (the heart of this persona), Minimap (find the good spots and the wrecks), Better Graphics (the map has never looked better for cruising), Traffic Car Expansion, Lights on Switches.

4.7 How to start a persona run

1. Start a new game and play one morning to confirm everything works.
2. Quit, open the save with MSC Editor, and set your persona’s name in `defaultES2File.txt` (`playerfirstname / playerlastname`).
3. Write your house rules somewhere visible — three lines on paper beats a forgotten promise.
4. Launch, and play the persona’s priorities from day one.

Persona	Difficulty	Signature mods
The Restorer	Medium	Visual Wear, Better Graphics, Satsuma Gauges Revamp, Lights on Switches
The Rally Driver	Medium	Traffic Car Expansion, Better Graphics, Satsuma Gauges Revamp, Visual Wear
The Workhorse	Medium	Cassette Tapes, Minimap, Openable Cabinets, Traffic Car Expansion, Visual Wear
The Stoic	Hard	Visual Wear, Reharmonization, Better Graphics
The Cruiser	Easy-going	Cassette Tapes, Minimap, Better Graphics, Traffic Car Expansion, Lights on Switches